

Week 2: The Story of the Bible

How to Read the Bible — 19-Week Study

The Bible can feel like a collection of separate stories — tonight we'll try to trace the shape of the whole thing, start to finish.

1. Think about the stories you grew up with — fairy tales, family stories, the "story" your country tells about itself. What made those stories powerful or sticky? Do you tend to think of the Bible more like that kind of shaping story, or more like a reference book you consult for answers?
2. **Read Genesis 1:27-28.** What does God tell the man and woman to do right after he creates them? What do you think it means to be made "in God's image," and how does that shape what you think humans are actually for?
3. **Read Genesis 3:6-7.** What does the woman see in the fruit that makes her want it, and what do she and Adam actually do — and what happens to them right afterward? Why do you think the temptation to define good and evil on our own terms, rather than trusting God's, is still so tempting for us today?
4. **Read Genesis 3:15.** What exactly does God say will happen between the serpent and the offspring of the woman? Why do you think God announces this hope so early, long before anyone could see how it would be fulfilled?
5. **Read Genesis 12:2-3.** What exactly does God promise Abraham in these verses? Why start small — one couple, one family — instead of fixing everything for the whole world all at once?
6. **Read Mark 1:14-15.** What exactly does Jesus announce, and what two things does he call people to do in response? Given everything Israel had been waiting for, why is this such a loaded, pivotal announcement?
7. **Read Matthew 28:5-6.** What does the angel actually tell the women at the tomb? What do you make of the claim that Jesus' resurrection didn't just reverse one death, but broke the power of evil and death themselves?

8. **Read Romans 3:21-26.** What does Paul say this righteousness from God is based on, and who does he say it's available to? How does this connect back to God's original promise to Abraham that all nations would be blessed through him?
9. **Read Revelation 21:1-4.** What does this passage say God will do, and what does it say will be gone for good? How does knowing where the story ends change the way you live in the middle of it, right now?
10. Now that you've seen the whole arc in one sitting, what's one book or story in the Bible you're curious to go back and reread with this bigger picture in mind?